



Understanding the

Canadian Diner

A snapshot of what Canadians
are craving – curated
exclusively for **Boston Pizza**



What **‘value’** really means to diners today

Canadians aren’t chasing cheap –
they want to feel good about what
they spend when they eat out

70%

say food **quality**
matters most (vs. 49%
who choose based on
value for money)

42%

see food and drink
as a way to **treat**
themselves

Value today is about **quality, experience**, and a little reassurance it’s worth it



Why **'Made in Canada'** still matters



Local, homegrown ingredients are a powerful differentiator in a sea of 'Canadian' claims



77%

of travellers plan to stay within Canada in 2025 (up from 69% last year)

68%

are more likely to visit restaurants that are Canadian-owned or source local ingredients



Canadians connect with brands that feel local and authentic —
'Made in Canada'
remains a powerful symbol of pride and belonging



Why menu innovation is today's biggest traffic-driver

★ Younger diners are rewarding creativity by choosing restaurants that surprise them with unique menu experiences



75%

of young adults choose restaurants for innovative, hard-to-replicate foods

64%

say offering new and exciting products is very important when choosing where to eat

Unique, must-try menu items drive discovery, bring in new guests and keep operators ahead of the curve



Quick tip:
**chicken is the
ultimate menu hack
right now**

Chicken delivers what diners want: high protein,
broad appeal, and endless room to innovate



71%

claim they want to
consume more protein

90%

of Canadian consumers
care about having enough
protein in their diet

82%

recognize chicken
as a leading protein
source — well ahead
of **pork at 53%**

**Versatile, satisfying,
and flavour-packed,
chicken leads menu
growth, crosses
cuisines and fits
perfectly into how
Canadians want
to eat today**



The rise of **veggie-forward** proteins

It's not about cutting meat; preference have shifted toward proteins made from real and recognizable ingredients that deliver nutrition

50%

of Canada's population will be **immigrants or their kids by 2040** and half of those households report a **meat-related dietary** restriction today

72%

of diners pick restaurants with menus that offer something for **everyone at the table** – inclusivity drives group dining decisions



Menus are more diverse than ever.

Veggie-forward protein dishes help everyone feel included and open the door to new flavours





Global flavours are redefining Canadian cravings



Bolder, authentic tastes are fueling a
new era of culinary exploration



72%

of diners choose
restaurants to try
unique, craveable
items they can't
make at home



50%

of consumers are
experimenting
with new flavours
more often

Nearly

1/3

of Gen Z and
Millennial eating
occasions are driven
by exploration



Gen Z and Millennials are
driving a new wave of flavour
exploration, seeking bold,
authentic, and
globally inspired
dishes that
surprise them



How 'limited time only' builds loyalty

For younger diners, exclusivity drives excitement — they want to be the first to try what everyone else can't get

4 in 10

Younger Diners have abandoned a brand they were once loyal to because they grew 'bored' of them

10,000

projected LTOs in 2025
— more than 2.5x the annual executions from just two years ago



Younger diners expect brands to stay culturally fluent — win with them by offering novelty & exclusivity



Sources:

- Maple Leaf Foods
- Restaurants Canada Foodservice Facts 2025
- Technomic
- Circana
- Statistics Canada
- Innova Market Insights
- Canadian Grocer